YUHAN WANG

CONTACT

Department of Agricultural and Applied Economics
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EDUCATION

University of Wisconsin - Madison
M.S., Applied Economics (completed); GPA: 4.0/4.0 — *2019 - 2021*
M.S., Computer Science (completed) — *2021 - 2023*
M.S., Applied Economics (in progress) — *2021 - Present*

Peking University — *2015 - 2019*
B.S., Life Sciences (Bioinformatics track)
B.A., Economics
GPA: 3.59/4.0

Uppsala University — *Summer 2017*
Summer Session, Sweden Nature

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Agricultural Economics, Environmental and Resource Economics, Agricultural Finance, Empirical Industrial Organization, Applied Econometrics, Climate Adaptation

RESEARCH PROJECTS

Working Papers

- *A Text-Based Measure of Farm Bill Uncertainty and Its Effects on Agricultural Credit* (with Xiaodong Du)
- *Technology, Risk, and Climate Adaptation: Corn Specialization in the U.S. Corn Belt* (with Xiaodong Du, Xueying Sun)
- *Demand, Markups, and Counterfactuals in U.S. Poultry Shipments: Evidence from Linked Commodity Flow and Manufacturing Microdata*

Selected Work in Progress

- How Does Climate Change Affect the Farmland Allocation and Trade Flow in the U.S.?
- U.S. Meat Market Demand Analysis using Nielsen Data

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Researcher, U.S. Meat Market Demand Analysis, UW-Madison AAE — *2020 - Present*
Individual Researcher, VIX Trading Strategies, City University of Hong Kong — *2018*
Researcher, Dimensionality Reduction Algorithms in Julia, Peking University — *2018 - 2019*
Summer Visiting Researcher, Uppsala University — *2017*

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Quantitative Strategy Researcher, Alphafund Investment Company, Beijing — *2018 - 2019*
Audit Intern, HSYH Accounting Firm, Beijing — *2018*

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

AAE421: Economic Decision Analysis (001), FA22 — *Principal Instructor*
AAE722: Machine Learning in Applied Economic Analysis (001), GFF SU21 — *TA*
AAE722: Machine Learning in Applied Economic Analysis (001), FA22 — *TA*
Mathematics and Chemistry Teacher, TAL Education Group, Beijing — *2017 - 2018*

HONORS, SCHOLARSHIPS, AND FELLOWSHIPS

Deborah and David Penn Ag and Applied Economics Graduate Student Fund — *2025*
Barbara Forrest Student Award — *2024*
Deborah and David Penn Ag and Applied Economics Graduate Student Fund — *2023*
UW-Madison Graduate School Conference Presentation Award — *2022*
First Prize, National Mathematics Competition — *2015*
First Prize, National Chemistry Competition — *2015*

CONFERENCES & SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

2025: AAEA & WAEA Joint Annual Meeting, Denver, CO, July 27-29; Poster Presentation: *Agricultural Lending Under Policy Uncertainty* (with Sheldon Du)
2024: AAEA Annual Meeting, New Orleans, LA, July 28-30; Poster Presentation: *How Does Climate Change Affect the Farmland Allocation and Trade Flow in the U.S.?*

SERVICES & OTHER ACTIVITIES

UW Madison AAE Seminar Organizer	*2023 - 2024*
Core Member, Peking University Life Science Industry Association	*2015 - 2017*
Leader, Peking University School of Life Sciences Student Union	*2015 - 2017*
Team Member, Peking University Yuanhuo Chess and Card Club	*2019*

SKILLS

Computing	C/C++, R, Python, Julia, SQL, Excel, MATLAB, Stata, Java, Microsoft Office, LaTeX
Languages	English (fluent), Mandarin Chinese (native)
Credentials	ACCA F1-F3 Pass; TOEFL 106; GMAT 710

ABSTRACTS

A Text-Based Measure of Farm Bill Uncertainty and Its Effects on Agricultural Credit (with Xiaodong Du)

Abstract: This paper develops a text-based measure of Farm Bill uncertainty and studies its effects on U.S. agricultural credit supply. It constructs a Farm Bill Uncertainty Index using a two-stage BERT classifier applied to newspaper articles, identifying Farm Bill coverage and isolating language related to legislative delay, disagreement, and procedural impasse. Merging the index with institution-level data for commercial banks, credit unions, and Farm Credit System institutions, the paper shows that higher uncertainty reduces agricultural lending, with the clearest effects among commercial banks. Event-study evidence around major Farm Bill episodes points to a supply-side channel in agricultural credit markets.

Technology, Risk, and Climate Adaptation: Corn Specialization in the U.S. Corn Belt (with Xiaodong Du, Xueying Sun)

Abstract: This paper studies how technological change facilitates climate adaptation in agricultural land use by examining the evolution of corn specialization in the U.S. Corn Belt. It constructs a county-level Technical Change Index using agro-ecological yield-potential data and combines it with long-run data on land use, weather, and crop insurance outcomes. Reduced-form evidence shows that higher technological capacity increases corn specialization and is associated with lower crop-insurance loss ratios. A structural discrete-choice model shows that technology raises returns to specialization, lowers adjustment frictions, and reduces exposure to downside weather risk, helping explain the persistence and spatial evolution of specialized production systems.

Demand, Markups, and Counterfactuals in U.S. Poultry Shipments: Evidence from Linked Commodity Flow and Manufacturing Microdata

Abstract: This paper estimates a random-coefficients demand system with Bertrand pricing for U.S. poultry shipments using Commodity Flow Survey records linked to manufacturing establishments through the Longitudinal Business Database. Products are establishment-commodity pairs and markets are destination-county-year cells. The estimates imply heterogeneous price sensitivity, negative demand effects of shipment distance, and sizable markups. Counterfactual exercises show that plant closures reduce welfare, shorter shipment distances raise welfare, and broader common ownership materially increases prices. The framework adapts differentiated-products methods to freight microdata and highlights the importance of geography and ownership in downstream procurement markets.

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